FAX COVER SHEET

Date: 03/12/2026
From: Lodestar WC Intake (combined packet)
To: Lodestar Claims Management - WC Intake
Number of pages (including cover): 21
Re: Okafor, WC-2025-PA-114220 - medical records for review

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UPMC MERCY | Emergency Department | 1400 Locust St, Pittsburgh, PA

EMERGENCY DEPARTMENT VISIT - MEDICAL RECORD

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Date/Time of Arrival: 01/06/2025 10:20 MRN: UPM-88310452

Employer: Allegheny Freight & Logistics Inc.

Date/Time of Injury: 01/06/2025 08:45 Place of Injury: Allegheny Freight dock 3, Pittsburgh, PA

Mechanism of Injury: Twisted while lifting a 70 lb freight box from a pallet onto a conveyor; immediate low back pain.

Chief Complaint: Low back pain radiating to the right buttock and thigh.

Physical Examination: Paraspinal spasm L3-S1. Flexion limited to 20 degrees. Straight leg raise positive on the right at 50 degrees.

Diagnostic Testing: X-ray lumbar spine 3 views: no fracture; mild loss of disc height at L5-S1.

Diagnosis: Strain of muscle and tendon of lower back (S39.012A); Low back pain (M54.50).

Medications Prescribed: Cyclobenzaprine 10 mg three times daily as needed x 10 days; Naproxen 500 mg twice daily.

Work Status: Off work 01/06/2025 through 01/10/2025; follow up with primary care.

Provider: Amanda Ruiz, MD - Emergency Medicine

EMPLOYER'S FIRST REPORT OF INJURY (FROI) - COMMONWEALTH OF PENNSYLVANIA (LIBC-344)

Employer: Allegheny Freight & Logistics Inc., 2100 Railroad St, Pittsburgh, PA 15222

Employee: Daniel R. Okafor Occupation: Dock Loader / Forklift Operator Date of Hire: 03/14/2016

Date of Injury: 01/06/2025 Time of Injury: 8:45 AM Place: Dock 3

Description of Accident: While lifting a freight box (approx. 70 lb) from a pallet to a conveyor the employee twisted and felt sharp low back pain.

Mechanism: Lifting/twisting Nature of Injury: Strain Part of Body: Low back (lumbar spine)

Witnesses: Maria Kowalski, dock supervisor

Date Reported to Employer: 01/06/2025 Lost Time: Yes, beginning 01/07/2025

EMPLOYER'S FIRST REPORT OF INJURY (FROI) - continued

Insurer: Keystone Mutual Casualty Third Party Administrator: Lodestar Claims Management

Claim Number: WC-2025-PA-114220 Assigned Adjuster: Jennifer Hartwell, AIC

Job Physical Demands: Heavy - lift up to 75 lb occasionally and 35 lb frequently; forklift operation.

Report Prepared By: Kevin Brandt, Harbor Point Benefits Group (TPA intake / employer benefits representative)

Date Prepared: 01/08/2025

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

ORTHOPEDIC SPINE CONSULTATION

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Date of Service: 02/02/2025 Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery

Reason for Consultation: Low back pain with right leg radiculopathy after work injury on 01/06/2025.

Symptoms: Low back pain 7/10 radiating to the right posterior thigh and lateral foot.

Physical Exam: Straight leg raise positive on the right at 40 degrees. Diminished right Achilles reflex.

Assessment: Lumbar radiculopathy, right S1 distribution (M54.16); suspected L5-S1 disc herniation.

Causation: Within a reasonable degree of medical certainty the condition is causally related to the 01/06/2025 work injury.

Plan: MRI lumbar spine without contrast. Physical therapy 2 times per week for 6 weeks (12 visits).

Medications: Hydrocodone-acetaminophen 5-325 mg every 6 hours as needed #30.

Work Status: Modified duty - no lifting over 15 lb, no repetitive bending.

Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 02/02/2025

ALLEGHENY DIAGNOSTIC IMAGING | 1001 Liberty Ave, Pittsburgh, PA

MRI LUMBAR SPINE WITHOUT CONTRAST - RADIOLOGY REPORT

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Date of Service: 02/09/2025 Ordering Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery

Technique: Multiplanar multisequence imaging without contrast.

Findings:

L5-S1: Right paracentral disc protrusion contacting the descending right S1 nerve root.

Impression: Right paracentral L5-S1 disc protrusion contacting the right S1 nerve root.

Radiologist: Peter Novak, MD

Electronically signed: 02/09/2025

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

ORTHOPEDIC SPINE CONSULTATION

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Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 02/02/2025

PEAK MOTION PHYSICAL THERAPY | 7700 Perry Hwy, Pittsburgh, PA

PHYSICAL THERAPY INITIAL EVALUATION

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Visit Date: 02/06/2025 Visit: 1 of 12 Therapist: Brian Walsh, PT, DPT

Referring Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery

Diagnosis: Lumbar radiculopathy (M54.16). Body Part: Lumbar spine.

Subjective: Patient reports low back pain 7/10 with right leg symptoms; difficulty lifting and sitting.

Objective: Lumbar flexion 35 percent of normal. Oswestry Disability Index 56 percent. Core endurance poor.

Assessment: Impairments in mobility, strength and functional tolerance consistent with lumbar radiculopathy.

Goals: Pain 2/10; Oswestry below 20 percent; return to heavy duty lifting 75 lb.

Plan: Physical therapy 2 times per week for 6 weeks (12 visits).

Work Restrictions/Functional Status: Per physician.

Therapist Signature: Brian Walsh, PT, DPT 02/06/2025

PEAK MOTION PHYSICAL THERAPY | 7700 Perry Hwy, Pittsburgh, PA

PHYSICAL THERAPY PROGRESS NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Visit Date: 03/19/2025 Visit: 12 of 36 Therapist: Brian Walsh, PT, DPT

Diagnosis: Lumbar radiculopathy (M54.16). Body Part: Lumbar spine.

Subjective: Patient reports low back pain 5/10. Sitting tolerance limited.

Objective: Lumbar flexion 60 percent of normal. Oswestry Disability Index 44 percent.

Treatment: Therapeutic exercise (CPT 97110) 30 minutes; manual therapy (CPT 97140) 15 minutes; neuromuscular re-education.

Response: Minimal change since last week.

Plan: Continue plan of care.

PEAK MOTION PHYSICAL THERAPY | 7700 Perry Hwy, Pittsburgh, PA

PHYSICAL THERAPY PROGRESS NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Visit Date: 05/01/2025 Visit: 24 of 36 Therapist: Brian Walsh, PT, DPT

Diagnosis: Lumbar radiculopathy (M54.16). Body Part: Lumbar spine.

Subjective: Patient reports low back pain 5/10. Sitting tolerance limited.

Objective: Lumbar flexion 60 percent of normal. Oswestry Disability Index 44 percent.

Treatment: Therapeutic exercise (CPT 97110) 30 minutes; manual therapy (CPT 97140) 15 minutes; neuromuscular re-education.

Response: Pain unchanged; progress has plateaued.

Plan: Continue plan of care.

PEAK MOTION PHYSICAL THERAPY | 7700 Perry Hwy, Pittsburgh, PA

PHYSICAL THERAPY PROGRESS NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Visit Date: 06/05/2025 Visit: 36 of 36 Therapist: Brian Walsh, PT, DPT

Diagnosis: Lumbar radiculopathy (M54.16). Body Part: Lumbar spine.

Subjective: Patient reports low back pain 5/10. Sitting tolerance limited.

Objective: Lumbar flexion 60 percent of normal. Oswestry Disability Index 44 percent.

Treatment: Therapeutic exercise (CPT 97110) 30 minutes; manual therapy (CPT 97140) 15 minutes; neuromuscular re-education.

Response: Pain unchanged; progress has plateaued.

Plan: Continue plan of care.

UPMC MERCY | Department of Surgery | Pittsburgh, PA

OPERATIVE REPORT

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Date of Surgery: 06/30/2025 Location: UPMC Mercy, OR 4

Preoperative Diagnosis: Right L5-S1 disc herniation with S1 radiculopathy (M51.17).

Procedure Performed: Right L5-S1 hemilaminotomy and microdiscectomy (CPT 63030).

Indication for Surgery: Progressive right S1 motor deficit with concordant MRI despite conservative care.

Intraoperative Findings: Sequestered disc fragment compressing the right S1 nerve root.

Estimated Blood Loss: 40 mL. Complications: None.

Surgeon Signature: Victoria Chen, MD Date: 06/30/2025

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

POST-OPERATIVE FOLLOW-UP NOTE

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Date of Service: 03/02/2026 Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery

Surgery Performed: Right L5-S1 microdiscectomy on 06/30/2025.

Interval History: Repeat MRI lumbar spine performed 02/02/2026 at Allegheny Diagnostic Imaging was reviewed.

Symptoms: Back pain 5/10, unchanged over the last 3 months.

Assessment: Persistent mechanical low back pain after microdiscectomy; functional plateau.

MMI: Patient has not yet reached maximum medical improvement. Anticipate MMI in approximately 4 months (08/2026).

Medications: Oxycodone 5 mg every 8 hours as needed #45 refilled.

Work Status: Modified duty per FCE - light duty, lifting up to 20 lb occasionally and 10 lb frequently.

Signed: Victoria Chen, MD 03/02/2026

WORKFIT FUNCTIONAL TESTING | 90 Industry Dr, Coraopolis, PA

FUNCTIONAL CAPACITY EVALUATION (FCE) REPORT

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Evaluation Date: 02/15/2026 Evaluator: Carla Jensen, OTR/L, CEAS

Job Requirements: Dock Loader - Heavy physical demand level (lift 75 lb occasionally, 35 lb frequently).

Consistency of Effort: Valid effort - 20 of 22 consistency measures within expected limits.

Work Capacity Classification: LIGHT physical demand level.

Can the patient meet job demands: No - the job requires the heavy physical demand level.

Functional Limitations/Restrictions: Lift/carry maximum 20 lb occasionally and 10 lb frequently; no repetitive bending.

RTW Recommendations: Return to work at light duty; vocational assessment recommended.

INDEPENDENT MEDICAL EVALUATIONS OF PENNSYLVANIA | 600 Grant St, Pittsburgh, PA

INDEPENDENT MEDICAL EXAMINATION (IME) REPORT

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Date of Service: 03/19/2026 Provider: Robert Feldman, MD - Orthopedic Surgery (Independent Examiner)
Physical Exam: Lumbar flexion 60 degrees, strength 5/5, straight leg raise negative.
Assessment: Status post L5-S1 microdiscectomy (M51.17) with residual mechanical low back pain.
MMI: In my opinion the claimant has reached maximum medical improvement as of this examination.
Impairment Rating: 8% whole person impairment per AMA Guides 6th edition.
Work Status: Light duty per FCE restrictions.
Signed: Robert Feldman, MD

(continued)

Review of Systems: Negative except as noted in the history of present illness.

Social History: Married, two children. Works full time as a dock loader/forklift operator.

Family History: Non-contributory.

Patient education provided; questions answered.

CVS PHARMACY #2291 | Pharmacy Prescription History

PHARMACY / PRESCRIPTION RECORDS

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Rx 8100400 | Hydrocodone-Acetaminophen 5-325 mg tablet | Qty 30 | 1 tab every 6 hours as needed | Prescriber: Victoria Chen, MD | Rx Date 02/02/2025 | Filled 02/02/2025 | Refills 0 | Status: Completed

Rx 8100437 | Hydrocodone-Acetaminophen 7.5-325 mg tablet | Qty 60 | 1 tab every 6 hours as needed | Prescriber: Rahul Iyer, MD | Rx Date 03/17/2025 | Filled 03/17/2025 | Refills 0 | Status: Completed

Rx 8100474 | Oxycodone HCl 5 mg tablet | Qty 60 | 1 tab every 6 hours as needed | Prescriber: Victoria Chen, MD | Rx Date 06/10/2025 | Filled 06/10/2025 | Refills 0 | Status: Completed

Rx 8100511 | Oxycodone HCl 5 mg tablet | Qty 45 | 1 tab every 6 hours as needed | Prescriber: Victoria Chen, MD | Rx Date 09/25/2025 | Filled 09/25/2025 | Refills 0 | Status: Completed

Rx 8100548 | Oxycodone HCl 5 mg tablet | Qty 45 | 1 tab every 6 hours as needed | Prescriber: Victoria Chen, MD | Rx Date 12/08/2025 | Filled 12/08/2025 | Refills 0 | Status: Completed

HEALTH INSURANCE CLAIM FORM - CMS-1500 (02/12)

Billing Provider: Allegheny Diagnostic Imaging

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Insured: Allegheny Freight & Logistics / Lodestar Claims Management Condition related to employment: YES

21. Diagnosis or nature of illness or injury: A. M51.17

24. Dates of Service | Place of Service | CPT/HCPCS | Units | Charges

02/02/2026 | 22 | 72148 MRI lumbar spine without contrast | 1 | $1,320.00

THREE RIVERS SPINE & ORTHOPEDICS | 300 Penn Center Blvd, Pittsburgh, PA

UTILIZATION REVIEW REQUEST - REQUEST FOR AUTHORIZATION

Patient: Daniel R. Okafor DOB: 07/11/1979 Claim #: WC-2025-PA-114220

Request Date: 03/04/2026 Requesting Provider: Victoria Chen, MD - Orthopedic Spine Surgery
Requested Treatment: L5-S1 posterior lumbar fusion (CPT 22612) with instrumentation.
Diagnosis: Status post microdiscectomy with discogenic low back pain (M51.17).
Response Requested By: 03/18/2026